SEO DISCUSSION

1. Define SEO and its purpose:

SEO (Search Engine Optimization) is the process of optimizing a website to rank higher on search engines like Google. Its purpose in web development is to increase visibility, drive organic traffic, and ensure the site reaches the target audience. For Pretoria Archdiocese, SEO helps people searching "Catholic Church Pretoria" find us.

2. How SEO improves UX and performance:

SEO practices improve UX by enforcing fast loading, mobile-responsive design, and clear navigation. Good structure with semantic HTML, alt text, and meta tags helps users and search engines understand content. My site uses responsive media queries and flex/grid layout, which improves both performance and user experience.

3. Benefits of implementing SEO:

Benefits include higher search rankings, more volunteers and sponsors for the NPO, better credibility, and cost-effective marketing. SEO ensures the Pretoria Archdiocese website is accessible on mobile and loads fast, increasing engagement and trust.

4. SEO techniques using HTML, CSS, JS:

HTML: Used meta description, keywords, title tags, alt attributes on all images (`alt="Pretoria Archdiocese Logo"`), and semantic tags `<header> <main> <footer>`. CSS: Used external stylesheet in `CSS/style.css` for faster caching, optimized typography and layout. JavaScript: Used in `js/script.js` for form validation to reduce bounce rate and improve interactivity, which Google rewards.

5. Purpose of HTML meta elements:

Meta elements provide metadata about the webpage for browsers and search engines, not visible to users. They are placed in `<head>`. Examples implemented:

<meta name="description" content="Official Pretoria Archdiocese website - Mass times, volunteer opportunities">

<meta name="keywords" content="Pretoria Archdiocese, Catholic Church Pretoria, volunteer NPO">

<meta name="author" content="st10534868">

<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">

Description improves click-through rate, keywords help ranking, viewport ensures mobile SEO.